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ASIA WEEK AHEAD AUSTRALIA CHINA

Asia week ahead: Australia rate decision, data on China, India, Japan

Australia's rate decision is the highlight of the week. Key data releases include China's inflation and credit, India's July CPI, and Japan's June current account balance and July PPI



Asia Research highlights of the week

[Taiwan's double-digit GDP growth extends into the second quarter](#)

[Taiwan's sticky inflation strengthens the case for a September hike](#)

[Asia FX Talking: Washington steps in to stop the Asian slide](#)

Australia : RBA expected to keep rates unchanged

We expect the Reserve Bank of Australia to hold the cash rate at 4.35% at Tuesday's monetary policy meeting. Inflation surprised decisively to the downside in the second quarter. Headline CPI eased to 3.9% year-on-year, well below the RBA's 4.8% forecast, driven by softer housing

and transport costs. While services increased to 4.0% YoY, the RBA's preferred trimmed mean CPI series fell below its estimate of 3.8% YoY. It stands at 3.6% YoY, suggesting underlying prices continue to moderate gradually. Collectively, price pressures are easing faster than the RBA envisaged, strengthening the case for an extended hold through year-end.

China: CPI and PPI seen moderating

China releases its inflation data over the weekend. We expect CPI inflation to edge down slightly to 0.9% YoY in July, and PPI inflation to cool to 3.8%. Purchasing managers' index data showed ex-factory prices cooling. China's credit data should be released sometime during the week. We expect weak credit demand to continue amid limited corporate investment appetite and soft consumer borrowing.

India: Headline inflation expected to remain steady

India releases its July CPI inflation data on Wednesday. The market expects inflation to remain unchanged at 4.4% YoY. Food inflation should soften from June's elevated 5.1%, supported by ample cereal stocks. Fuel inflation, however, is set to edge higher as recent petrol, diesel and compressed natural gas (CNG) price hikes continue to pass through. Services inflation is expected to remain sticky, reflecting persistent underlying cost pressures.

Japan: PPI and current account

Japan's key data releases include the June current account balance on Monday, and July PPI on Thursday. The consensus expects producer prices to rise to 7.5% YoY from 7.1% in June. This reflects continued upstream price pressure from higher energy prices, yen weakness and import costs.

Key events in Asia next week

Country	Time (GMT+8)	Data/event	ING	Prev.
Sunday 9 August				
China	0930	Jul CPI Inflation (YoY%)	0,9	1
	0930	Jul PPI (YoY%)	3,8	4,1
Monday 10 August				
Japan	0750	Jun Current Account (JPY bn)	CF:1577	3968
Indonesia	1100	Jul Consumer Confidence	-	117,8
Tuesday 11 August				
Australia	1230	Rate Decision (%)	4,35	4,35
Malaysia	1200	Jun Industrial Output (YoY%)	-	8,4
Indonesia	1100	Jun Retail Sales (YoY%)	-	-3,9
Wednesday 12 August				
South Korea	0700	Jul Unemployment Rate (%)	-	2,7
India	1830	Jul CPI Inflation (YoY%)	CF: 4,4	4,4
Thursday 13 August				
Japan	0750	Jul PPI (YoY%)	CF:7,5	7,1
China	1700	Jul Money Supply (YoY%)	-	8
Friday 14 August				
India	1430	Jul WPI Inflation (YoY%)	-	9,9
	1230	FX Reserves (USD bn)	-	682,4
Malaysia	1200	Q2 Current Account (MYR bn)	-	15,2
	1200	Q2 GDP Final (YoY%)	-	5,4

Note : CF = Market consensus forecast data

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